

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 5

New Case: Aryan – Behavioral Activation & Cognitive Work
Full Detailed – More Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Aryan (32 y/o Male)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	5 of 18–20	Focus:	Behavioral activation + Cognitive work

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client had mixed results again this week. Worry Time helped on some days but not others. He attempted problem-solving on one work issue with partial success. He reports feeling more tired and less motivated overall (signs of burnout). Today's plan: Review homework, introduce **behavioral activation** (small activity scheduling) to address low energy/motivation, continue cognitive restructuring, and assign integrated homework.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Aryan. How has your week been? Let's review the homework.

Client: It was average. Worry Time helped on 3–4 days, but on other days I couldn't postpone the worries. I tried problem-solving on one issue at work and it helped a bit. But overall I'm feeling more tired and less motivated than before.

Therapist: Thank you for sharing that. Feeling more tired and less motivated is common when someone is experiencing burnout. We can work on that today. First, let's look at what helped with the problem-solving.

INTRODUCING BEHAVIORAL ACTIVATION

Therapist: When people feel burned out and low in motivation, one effective approach is called **Behavioral Activation**. The idea is to gradually increase small, manageable activities that give a sense of pleasure or achievement, even when motivation is low. This can help improve energy and mood over time. Would you like to try this?

Client: I don't know... I already feel like I don't have energy for anything extra.

Therapist: That's a very common feeling. We start with very small activities — things that take 5–10 minutes and don't require much energy. For example, stepping outside for 5 minutes, listening to one song you like, or having a short conversation with your wife. The goal is to gently increase activity rather than push yourself hard.

Client: Okay... I can try small things.

Therapist: Great. Let's pick 2–3 small activities you can try this week and schedule them.

CONTINUING COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING

Therapist: Last session your belief in "I have to be perfect or they will start doubting me" was around 60%. How much do you believe it now?

Client: Still around 55–60%. It hasn't changed much.

Therapist: That's okay. Change in these deeper beliefs usually happens gradually as we keep collecting real-life evidence. The behavioral experiments and daily experiences will help strengthen the balanced thought over time.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Time practice
2. Schedule and do 2–3 small pleasurable or achievement activities (5–15 minutes each)
3. Continue rating belief in the old thought and using the balanced thought
4. Try one small behavioral experiment (time limit on a task)

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your mixed week, introduced Behavioral Activation to help with low energy, and continued cognitive work. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: The small activities idea makes sense, but I'm not sure if I'll have the energy. I'll try.

Therapist: That's fair. We'll start very small. Any questions?

Client: No.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client continues to have mixed results with techniques — realistic.
- Signs of burnout becoming more prominent (low motivation, fatigue).
- Behavioral Activation introduced to address low energy/motivation.
- Belief in old thought remains stable (~55-60%) — normal at this stage.
- Next session: Review Behavioral Activation attempts, continue cognitive work, deepen problem-solving if needed.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.